

Lü Pin 吕频

Biography

Short

Lü Pin 吕频 is a Ph.D. candidate in political science at Rutgers University. Her research is situated at the intersection of authoritarian politics, social movements, and gender politics, with China as its empirical focus. Outside the academy, she has worked in China's feminist movement for close to thirty years.

Full

Lü Pin 吕频 is a Ph.D. candidate in political science at Rutgers University, with the degree expected in summer 2027. Her research is situated at the intersection of authoritarian politics, social movements, and gender politics, with China as its empirical focus.

Her dissertation develops the concept of reconfigurative adaptation to explain why China's feminist movement remained active under intensifying repression between 2013 and 2023. Drawing on an original database of more than 500 mobilization events and more than 50 interviews with activists, it shows that with each major crackdown the movement scaled back its political challenge while widening its social reach. Her second line of research develops the concept of the repression matrix, in which the police and state security agencies orchestrate violence that state and non-state actors with power over activists' everyday lives carry out in dispersed and continuous fashion.

Her articles have appeared in *Women's Studies International Forum* and *Politics & Gender*, and an article is forthcoming in *China Perspectives*. Her research has been supported by the Carrie Chapman Catt Prize for Research on Women and Politics and by the Women, Gender, and Politics Research Section of the American Political Science Association.

Outside the academy, she has worked in China's feminist movement for close to thirty years. In 2009 she founded *Feminist Voices*, the first and for a time the largest feminist media and advocacy platform in China, which censors shut down in 2018.